Carboplatin + Oral Etoposide

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00319 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before the visit

Confirm blood-test arrangements, transport, capsule prescription and the 24-hour contact number. Tell the team if you are unwell before travelling.

STEP 2

Time in the unit

Carboplatin runs into a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1. Etoposide is taken as capsules by mouth twice daily on Days 1–3, with the Day 1 sequence confirmed by the unit. The visit includes blood-result review, prevention medicines, preparation and observation. The pharmacy label gives your exact capsule strengths, number and times; do not calculate capsules from this guide.

STEP 3

Access for the infusion

The team selects a cannula or appropriate existing central line for carboplatin. Etoposide is taken by mouth, so this regimen does not normally require a take-home infusion pump.

STEP 4

Taking capsules home

Follow the prescribed capsule count and twice-daily Days 1–3 schedule exactly, using the written calendar to record each dose. Take capsules on an empty stomach with water; ask the pharmacist to explain the timing around food. Do not chew, open or crush capsules. If swallowing is difficult, contact the team before taking them; do not substitute an intravenous preparation or change the dose yourself.

STEP 5

Home support

Keep capsules in their original pack, away from children and excess heat or damp, following the supplied label. The manufacturer leaflet advises gloves for handling and washing hands afterwards. Do not open a blister with a leaking capsule; ask the pharmacist what to do. Return unused capsules through the pharmacy; do not put them in household waste or drains.

STEP 6

Bring to review

Bring the capsule dose record, current medicines list and symptom notes. Ask for help if remembering doses or managing the pack is difficult.

Sources: NCCP 00319 v5 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.